

AQA 7136 | EDEXCEL 9EC0

A-LEVEL ECONOMICS

THE COMPLETE YEAR

FREE SAMPLE | WEEK 1 OF 30

Week 1, complete

both taught lessons with tasks and full answers

The practice hour

question bank extract with answers

Retrieval starter, week 1

five questions with answers

The year map

all six units and every assessment point

From the full product

every week of the year is built like this one

Dual specification codes

AQA 7136 and Edexcel 9EC0 on every lesson

TRY ONE WEEK FREE | THE FULL YEAR IS BUILT LIKE THIS

THE SIX UNITS	WEEKS	ASSESSED BY
The economic problem and how markets work	1 to 5	40 marks, week 5
Elasticity and markets in action	6 to 10	40 marks, week 10
Market failure and government intervention	11 to 15	45 marks, week 15
Measuring the macroeconomy	16 to 20	45 marks, week 20
AD, AS and equilibrium	21 to 25	50 marks, week 25
The policy toolkit	26 to 30	50 marks, week 30

Written for AQA 7136 and Edexcel 9EC0, with both codes on every lesson. Includes the lesson index, the printable tracker, the command word page and the practice hour record.

HOW THIS YEAR WORKS

This is a full first teaching year for A-level Economics: 30 weeks, planned at three timetabled hours a week. Every week has two taught lessons, written out with objectives, timings, a worked task and full answers, and a third hour that runs on the unit question bank, the weekly retrieval starter and, in the closing week of each unit, the unit assessment. Everything needed for the third hour is inside this pack, so the year holds together without any other resource. The Word version makes every page editable, and the PowerPoint carries all 30 retrieval starters with answers, ready to project.

Which specification? Written for AQA 7136 and Edexcel 9EC0. Every lesson header carries both references: the AQA section and the Edexcel point, each with its name. The two specifications cover almost the same first year ground in a different order, and this scheme is sequenced so a class on either board follows it straight through.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE · ALL SIX UNITS

Unit	Weeks	AQA 7136	Edexcel 9EC0	Assessed by
1. The economic problem and how markets work	1 to 5	4.1.1 The economic problem, 4.1.3 Price determination, 4.1.4 specialisation	1.1 Nature of economics, 1.2 How markets work	Unit 1 assessment, 40 marks, week 5
2. Elasticity and markets in action	6 to 10	4.1.3 Price determination in a competitive market	1.2 How markets work	Unit 2 assessment, 40 marks, week 10
3. Market failure and government intervention	11 to 15	4.1.8 Market failure and government intervention	1.3 Market failure, 1.4 Government intervention	Unit 3 assessment, 45 marks, week 15
4. Measuring the macroeconomy	16 to 20	4.2.1 Measurement, 4.2.3 Economic performance	2.1 Measures of economic performance, 2.4 National income	Unit 4 assessment, 45 marks, week 20
5. AD, AS and equilibrium	21 to 25	4.2.2 How the macroeconomy works, 4.2.3 Economic performance	2.2 to 2.5 Aggregate demand to economic growth	Unit 5 assessment, 50 marks, week 25
6. The policy toolkit	26 to 30	4.2.4 Monetary policy, 4.2.5 Fiscal and supply side policies	2.6 Macroeconomic objectives and policies	Unit 6 assessment, 50 marks, week 30

UNIT 1: THE ECONOMIC PROBLEM AND HOW MARKETS WORK

WEEKS 1 TO 5 · AQA 4.1.1 Economic methodology and the economic problem, with 4.1.3 Price determination. Edexcel 1.1 Nature of economics and 1.2 How markets work

Where the course begins: what economics studies, why choice is unavoidable, and how a market turns millions of separate decisions into one price. The unit builds the two diagrams that carry the whole year, demand and supply, and closes with the first 40 mark assessment, which doubles as the year's baseline.

W1L1 · WHAT ECONOMICS STUDIES

AQA 4.1.1 Economic methodology and the economic problem | EDEXCEL 1.1.1 to 1.1.3 Nature of economics

Objective. Distinguish positive from normative statements, and state the economic problem in one sentence.

The hour: retrieval starter and review (10), then teaching (22), then the task below, the first few minutes spent reading the 6 items before pens move (25), then objective checked against evidence (3).

- Scarcity: wants are unlimited, resources are not. Every economy answers what to produce, how, and for whom.
- The four factors of production: land, labour, capital, enterprise. Their rewards: rent, wages, interest, profit.
- Positive statements can be tested against evidence. Normative statements carry a value judgement: look for ought, should, fair.
- Economists model to simplify. Ceteris paribus holds everything else still so one cause can be studied at a time.

THE TASK: SORTING THE CLAIMS

A radio phone in about fuel prices produces six claims. Students sort each as positive or normative, then justify the two hardest calls.

Claim	Statement
Claim A	Petrol duty raised prices at the pump by 4p a litre last month
Claim B	The government ought to cut fuel duty for rural drivers
Claim C	Higher pump prices reduced traffic volumes on motorways
Claim D	It is unfair that fuel takes a bigger share of a low income
Claim E	If duty rises again, demand for rail season tickets will rise
Claim F	Cutting duty would be the wrong signal for the climate

Q	Question	Marks
1	Sort the six claims into positive and normative.	(6)
2	For claims B and E, justify your sorting in one sentence each.	(4)
3	State the economic problem, using the word scarcity.	(2)

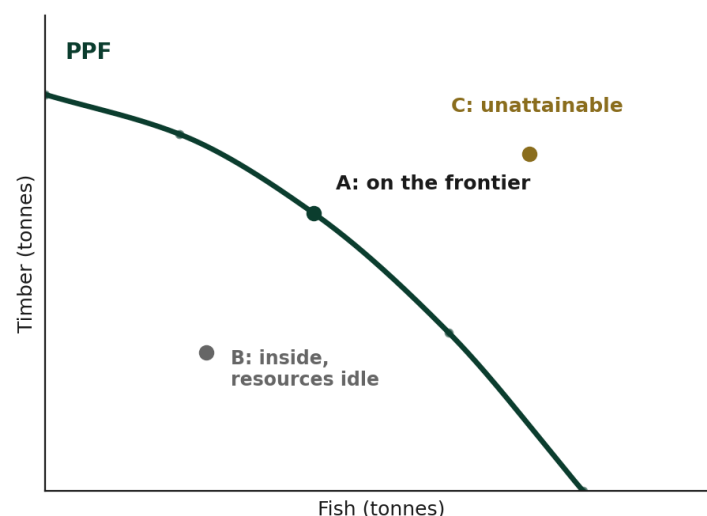
Q	Answer	Marking guidance
1	A, C, E positive; B, D, F normative	A and C claim testable facts; E is a testable prediction. B and F say ought or wrong; D says unfair. One mark per correct placement.
2	B normative, E positive	B: ought signals a value judgement, so normative. E: an if then prediction that data could confirm or refute, so positive even though it is about the future.
3	Scarcity forces choice	Resources are scarce while wants are unlimited, so every choice means giving something up.

W1L2 · OPPORTUNITY COST AND THE PPF**AQA 4.1.1 Economic methodology and the economic problem | EDEXCEL 1.1.4 Production possibility frontiers**

Objective. Calculate an opportunity cost, and read production possibilities from a frontier.

The hour: retrieval starter and review (10), then teaching, with the diagram built on the board (25), then the task below, the first few minutes spent reading the 5 items before pens move (22), then objective checked against evidence (3).

- Opportunity cost is the value of the next best alternative given up. It is the price tag scarcity puts on every choice.
- The PPF shows the maximum combinations of two goods an economy can produce with its resources fully employed.
- Points inside the frontier waste resources. Points on it are productively efficient. Points beyond it are unattainable today.
- Moving along the frontier is a trade off measured in the other good, and the frontier makes it visible.



THE TASK: AN ISLAND ECONOMY ON ONE CURVE

An island economy produces fish and timber. With all resources employed it can reach these combinations in a season.

Option	Season output
Option A	Fish 0 tonnes, timber 40 tonnes
Option B	Fish 10 tonnes, timber 36 tonnes
Option C	Fish 20 tonnes, timber 28 tonnes
Option D	Fish 30 tonnes, timber 16 tonnes
Option E	Fish 40 tonnes, timber 0 tonnes

Q	Question	Marks
1	Calculate the opportunity cost of moving from A to B, and from D to E.	(4)
2	Explain what the pattern in your two answers shows, and name the property.	(3)
3	The island currently produces 20 tonnes of fish and 20 tonnes of timber. Describe this point.	(2)
4	Give one change that could shift the whole frontier outward.	(2)

Q	Answer	Marking guidance
1	4 tonnes of timber; then 16 tonnes of timber	A to B: timber falls 40 to 36 for the first 10 tonnes of fish. D to E: timber falls 16 to 0 for the last 10 tonnes.
2	Rising opportunity cost	Each extra 10 tonnes of fish costs more timber than the last: 4, 8, 12, 16. Resources are not equally suited to both uses, so the frontier bows outward.
3	Inside the frontier	At 20 tonnes of fish the frontier allows 28 tonnes of timber; producing only 20 leaves resources unemployed or misused, so the point is productively inefficient.
4	More resources, or better technology	More or better resources, or better technology: for example new boats, faster saws, or training that raises productivity in either industry.

RETRIEVAL STARTERS · ALL 30 WEEKS

150 questions with answers, interleaved on purpose. Projectable from the PowerPoint.

WEEK 1

#	Question	Answer
1	Define scarcity.	Unlimited wants meeting limited resources.
2	Name the four factors of production.	Land, labour, capital, enterprise.
3	Positive or normative: The state should fund all universities.	Normative: should marks a value judgement.
4	What does ceteris paribus mean?	All other things held equal.
5	State the reward to enterprise.	Profit.

THE PRACTICE HOUR · QUESTION BANK EXTRACT

Three of Unit 1's twelve questions. The full bank runs every third hour of the year.

#	Question	Marks	Answer and guidance
A1	State the economic problem in one sentence.	(2)	Unlimited wants meet scarce resources, so choices must be made. Both halves needed.
A2	Name the four factors of production and one reward each.	(4)	Land: rent. Labour: wages. Capital: interest. Enterprise: profit.
A3	Positive or normative: The minimum wage should rise faster than inflation. Justify.	(2)	Normative: should signals a value judgement, not a testable claim.

THE OTHER 29 WEEKS

Every week of the full product is built exactly like this one: two taught lessons with tasks, data and full answers, a structured practice hour, a retrieval starter, and at the close of every unit an assessment with its complete mark scheme. 60 lessons, 72 bank questions, 270 assessed marks, 150 starter questions, 18 built diagrams, in PDF, editable Word and PowerPoint.

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